UNIT-1

UNDERSTANDING GENDER

INTRODUCTION

Gender is one of the most important aspects of human identity. It influences the opportunities, responsibilities, expectations, and treatment that individuals receive in society. Understanding gender helps create an inclusive, respectful, and equitable environment.

Gender sensitization promotes awareness of gender equality and encourages people to challenge stereotypes, discrimination, and violence based on gender.

GENDER

Gender refers to the socially and culturally constructed roles, behaviors, expectations, and responsibilities associated with being male, female, or other gender identities.These roles are learned through family, schools, media, religion, and society.

Definition

"Gender refers to socially constructed characteristics of women, men, girls, and boys."

Unlike biological differences, gender roles can change over time and vary from one culture to another.

SEX

Sex refers to biologically defined and genetically acquired differences between males and females, according to their physiology and reproductive capabilities or potentialities. It is universal and mostly unchanging, without surgery.

Difference between Sex and Gender

Sex	Gender
Biological	Social and cultural
Determined at birth	Learned through society
Universal	Varies across cultures
Cannot be easily changed	Can change over time
Based on anatomy	Based on roles and expectations

GENDER EQUITY

Gender Equity is the process of being fair to women and men. To ensure fairness, measures must be taken to compensate for historical and social disadvantages that prevent women and men from operating on a level playing field.

GENDER EQUALITY

Gender Equality is the state or condition that affords women and men equal enjoyment of human rights, socially valued goods, opportunities, and resources.

GENDER SOCIALIZATION

Socialization is the process that enables people to think about the expectations of society about them. People identify with the categories of feminine and masculine in this process. It is about the expected behavioural patterns and norms for men and women to exist within the society. The transmission of such values, norms happens in this process. People are exposed to social world through the cultural information of parents, care takers and so on. This process helps us to understand the embedded nature of gender in the process of socialization.

GENDER ROLES

Roles in the society are gendered in nature. Patriarchy determines the role of men and women. It is the mode of patriarchal ideology which prescribes specific role to men and women and they have to confirm those roles. Violation of gender roles become a taboo in the society. For instance role reversals are considered as deviances according to dominant male centred ethos of the society.

GENDER IDENTITY

It is the sense of people as male or female. It is related to our existence as male or female. The sense of identity creates interest in their life. For instance children imbibe the values and norms of the elderly people. It affects their sense of gender identity. Social construction of gender as well as the sexual difference are very much part of the process of gender identity. It is recognition of one‟s own identity. It is conditioned according to the dominant norms and values of the society. In other words Gender identity refers to how an individual personally identifies themselves.

It may or may not correspond to the sex assigned at birth.

Examples include:

- Male
- Female
- Transgender
- Non-binary
- Genderqueer

Every individual has the right to express their gender identity with dignity and respect.

GENDER EXPRESSION

Gender expression refers to the way a person expresses or presents their gender to others through their appearance, clothing, hairstyle, voice, body language, behavior, and mannerisms. It

is the outward expression of an individual's gender identity and may or may not match the sex assigned to them at birth.

Gender expression is influenced by personal preferences, culture, society, and traditions. It can vary from person to person, and there is no single way to express masculinity, femininity, or any other gender identity. For example, some people may prefer wearing traditional clothing, while others may choose styles that are considered gender-neutral.

It is important to understand that **gender expression is different from gender identity**. Gender identity is how a person feels about their own gender, whereas gender expression is how they present themselves to others. A person's gender expression does not determine their abilities, personality, or character.

GENDER ROLES

Gender roles are the behaviors, responsibilities, and expectations that society assigns to individuals based on their gender. These roles are not determined by biology but are created and influenced by culture, traditions, family, religion, media, and social norms. They guide how people are expected to behave, dress, work, and interact with others.

From childhood, boys and girls are often taught different roles. For example, boys may be encouraged to be strong, independent, and financially responsible, while girls may be expected to be caring, emotional, and responsible for household work. These expectations vary across cultures and can change over time.

Gender roles can influence a person's education, career choices, leadership opportunities, and family responsibilities. Traditional gender roles may limit an individual's freedom by discouraging them from pursuing interests or careers that do not fit societal expectations. For example, women can become engineers, scientists, or political leaders, and men can be teachers, nurses, or homemakers.

Modern society encourages equal opportunities and shared responsibilities for all genders. Challenging rigid gender roles helps promote gender equality, respect, and personal freedom,

allowing individuals to make choices based on their abilities and interests rather than societal expectations.

Examples of Gender Roles

- Men are expected to earn income for the family.
- Women are expected to take care of household work and children.
- Boys are encouraged to play outdoor sports.
- Girls are encouraged to help with household chores.

These are **traditional gender roles**, and they are changing as society moves towards greater equality.

GENDER BIAS

Society produces bias that is structured on the basis of gender identities. Unfair treatment based on gender.MPatriarchy strengthens the gender bias and recognises the society as a male dominated space. Thus, women face bias from the dominant patriarchal society. Practices of gender bias differ according to the diverse social stratification of societies. For instance girl children are killed because they are considered inferior to boys. Due to socialization process men tend to control women and women are forced to behave according to the interest of the men in the society. Thus gender bias is the construction of socialization process and it is the extension of patriarchal ideology.

GENDER DISCRIMINATION

Gender discrimination is the unfair or unequal treatment of a person because of their gender. It occurs when individuals are denied equal rights, opportunities, or benefits simply because they are male, female, or belong to another gender identity. Gender discrimination can take place at home, in schools, workplaces, and society.

Gender discrimination may affect access to education, employment, healthcare, property, promotions, wages, and leadership opportunities. For example, paying women lower salaries

than men for the same work, discouraging girls from pursuing higher education, or denying promotions based on gender are forms of gender discrimination.

Such discrimination creates inequality, limits personal growth, and affects the social and economic development of a country. It can also lead to harassment, violence, and reduced self-confidence among those who experience it.

Eliminating gender discrimination requires equal treatment, equal opportunities, respect for human rights, and strict enforcement of laws that protect individuals from unfair treatment. Education, awareness, and gender sensitization play an important role in reducing gender discrimination and promoting an inclusive society.

Examples of Gender Discrimination

- Paying women less than men for the same work.
- Denying girls the opportunity to pursue higher education.
- Refusing to hire a qualified person because of their gender.
- Preventing women from participating in leadership or decision-making roles.
- Assigning household work only to women because of traditional beliefs.

Effects of Gender Discrimination

- Unequal opportunities.
- Reduced self-confidence.
- Economic inequality.
- Limited career growth.
- Social injustice.
- Slower national development.

GENDER EQUALITY

Gender equality means that all people, regardless of their gender, have the same rights, opportunities, responsibilities, and access to resources. It ensures that everyone is treated fairly and has equal chances to participate in education, employment, healthcare, politics,

and decision-making. Gender equality does not mean that everyone is the same; rather, it means that no one should be discriminated against because of their gender.

- Gender equality promotes equal pay for equal work, equal access to education, equal participation in leadership roles, and equal protection under the law. It helps create a society where people are valued for their abilities and contributions rather than their gender. Achieving gender equality leads to social justice, economic growth, and sustainable development.

GENDER EQUITY

Gender equity means ensuring fairness and justice by providing individuals with the support and resources they need according to their different circumstances. It recognizes that some people may face greater challenges because of social, cultural, or historical inequalities, and therefore may require additional support to achieve equal outcomes.

Unlike equality, which gives everyone the same opportunities, equity provides people with what they need to succeed. For example, maternity leave for women, paternity leave for fathers, separate sanitation facilities, and workplace safety measures are examples of gender equity because they address different needs while promoting fairness.

Gender equity is an important step toward achieving gender equality, as it helps remove barriers that prevent equal participation in society.

Difference Between Gender Equality and Gender Equity

Gender Equality	Gender Equity
Means equal rights and opportunities for everyone.	Means fair treatment based on individual needs and circumstances.
Everyone receives the same opportunities.	People receive the support they need to achieve equal opportunities.

Gender Equality	Gender Equity
Focuses on equal treatment.	Focuses on fairness and justice.
Example: Equal pay for equal work.	Example: Providing maternity leave and accessible facilities to meet specific needs.

In simple words:

- **Gender Equality = Equal opportunities for all.**
- **Gender Equity = Fair support according to individual needs to achieve equality.**

GENDER SOCIALIZATION

Gender socialization is the lifelong process through which individuals learn the attitudes, behaviors, roles, and expectations that society considers appropriate for different genders. From childhood onwards, people are influenced by family, schools, peers, media, religion, and culture, which shape their understanding of how men, women, and people of other gender identities are expected to behave. These socially constructed expectations often influence an individual's interests, career choices, responsibilities, and interactions with others.

Gender socialization is not based on biological differences but on cultural beliefs and social norms. Since these norms vary across societies and change over time, gender roles are neither universal nor fixed. Positive gender socialization promotes equality, respect, and shared responsibilities, while negative gender socialization can reinforce stereotypes, discrimination, and unequal opportunities.

GENDER SENSITIZATION

means creating awareness about gender equality and teaching people to respect everyone, regardless of their gender. It helps people understand that men and women should have equal rights, equal opportunities, and equal respect in society.

Gender sensitization encourages people to avoid gender stereotypes, discrimination, and unfair treatment. It teaches that every individual should be valued based on their abilities and character, not because they are male or female.

It also helps people understand the importance of treating others with dignity, preventing gender-based violence and harassment, and promoting equal participation in education, employment, and decision-making.

Gender sensitization can be promoted through education, workshops, discussions, awareness campaigns, and community programs. These activities help people develop positive attitudes towards gender equality.

Objectives of Gender Sensitization

- To promote gender equality.
- To remove gender stereotypes and discrimination.
- To create respect for all genders.
- To ensure equal opportunities for everyone.
- To prevent gender-based violence and harassment.

Importance of Gender Sensitization

- Creates a safe and inclusive environment.
- Promotes equal rights and opportunities.
- Reduces discrimination and prejudice.
- Encourages mutual respect and understanding.
- Helps build a fair and peaceful society.

MASCULINITY

Masculinity refers to the qualities, behaviors, roles, and characteristics that a society traditionally associates with men and boys. These characteristics are influenced by culture, family, religion, media, and social norms rather than being determined entirely by biology. Different societies may have different ideas about what it means to be masculine.

Traditionally, masculinity has been associated with qualities such as strength, courage, confidence, leadership, independence, and responsibility. However, these characteristics are not exclusive to men, and not all men are expected to possess them. Modern views recognize that individuals should be free to express their personalities and emotions without being limited by traditional gender expectations.

Rigid ideas of masculinity can sometimes encourage harmful stereotypes, such as the belief that men should never cry, ask for help, or express emotions. Such stereotypes may negatively affect mental health and personal relationships. Healthy masculinity encourages qualities such as respect, kindness, responsibility, empathy, honesty, and equality while allowing men to express their emotions openly.

Promoting a positive understanding of masculinity helps create respectful relationships, reduces gender stereotypes, and supports gender equality in families, workplaces, and society.

Characteristics of Healthy Masculinity

- Respecting others regardless of gender.
- Taking responsibility for one's actions.
- Showing kindness and empathy.
- Expressing emotions in a healthy way.
- Supporting equality and fairness.
- Rejecting violence and discrimination.

FEMININITY

Femininity refers to the qualities, behaviors, roles, and characteristics that a society traditionally associates with women and girls. These characteristics are shaped by culture, traditions, family, media, and social expectations rather than being determined entirely by biology. The meaning of femininity varies across different cultures and changes over time.

Traditionally, femininity has been associated with qualities such as kindness, compassion, patience, care, empathy, gentleness, and cooperation. However, these qualities are not limited to

women, and women are capable of performing any role or profession based on their abilities and interests.

Traditional ideas of femininity may sometimes create stereotypes, such as expecting women to be responsible only for household work or discouraging them from pursuing careers in science, engineering, or leadership. Modern society recognizes that women should have the freedom to choose their education, career, lifestyle, and responsibilities without being restricted by gender stereotypes.

Healthy femininity encourages confidence, self-respect, independence, empathy, leadership, and equal participation in all areas of life. Respecting different expressions of femininity helps promote gender equality and an inclusive society.

Characteristics of Healthy Femininity

- Showing kindness and compassion.
- Being confident and self-reliant.
- Respecting others and oneself.
- Taking responsibility for personal decisions.
- Participating equally in education, employment, and leadership.
- Supporting equality and mutual respect.

PATRIARCHY

Patriarchy is a social system in which men hold greater power, authority, and control than women in the family, workplace, and society. In a patriarchal society, men are often given more importance in decision-making, property ownership, leadership, and public life, while women may have fewer opportunities and rights.

Patriarchy is based on traditional beliefs that men should be the heads of families and the primary decision-makers, while women should mainly take care of household responsibilities and children. These beliefs can lead to gender inequality, discrimination, and unequal access to education, employment, and leadership positions.

Patriarchal practices may also contribute to problems such as unequal pay, limited opportunities for women, gender-based violence, and restrictions on women's freedom and independence. However, many societies are working towards reducing patriarchal attitudes by promoting gender equality, women's empowerment, equal rights, and shared responsibilities.

Challenging patriarchy does not mean opposing men. Instead, it means creating a society where all people, regardless of gender, have equal rights, opportunities, respect, and freedom to make their own choices.

Characteristics of Patriarchy

- Men hold greater authority and decision-making power.
- Preference is often given to sons over daughters.
- Women may have fewer opportunities in education and employment.
- Traditional gender roles are strongly enforced.
- Leadership positions are often dominated by men.

Effects of Patriarchy

- Gender inequality.
- Gender discrimination.
- Unequal access to education and employment.
- Economic dependence of women.
- Gender-based violence and harassment.
- Limited participation of women in leadership and decision-making.

GENDER STEREOTYPE

Gender stereotypes are beliefs which prescribe what men and women should and what they can do. It can be changed over period of time. But, changes are very slow. We can see few examples of gender stereotypes. Women are supposed to be caring and nurturing, kind, warm and they should be interested in children. The above said qualities are perceived for women in most of the societies. The qualities like intelligence are valued in both men and women. In the South Asian Societies, women should be presentable and dress properly and they must be proficient in

household chores. With regard to profession, girls in Asian societies are encouraged to take up traditional professions like teaching or medicine predominantly, which are related to reproductive roles. i.e caring and nurturing. Other qualities prescribed for women as gender stereotypes are physical appearance. Society expects women to be thin. But there is no gender stereotyping on men about weight. Media especially print and visual media (Television) and cinema contribute to gender stereotyping. Most of the commercial cinemas and television serials portray men with masculine qualities. Women are mostly shown as dependent and they perform reproductive roles in popular cinema and television.

BINARY GENDER

Binary gender is the idea that there are only two genders—**male** and **female**. In this system, people are expected to identify as either a man or a woman based on the sex assigned to them at birth. Many societies have traditionally followed the binary concept of gender, although modern understanding recognizes greater gender diversity.

NON-BINARY

Non-binary is a gender identity of people who do not identify exclusively as male or female. A non-binary person may identify as both genders, neither gender, or somewhere between male and female. Their gender identity does not fit within the traditional gender binary.

It is important to respect each person's self-identified gender and preferred pronouns.

TRANSGENDER

Transgender refers to a person whose **gender identity is different from the sex assigned to them at birth**. For example, a person assigned male at birth may identify as a woman, or a person assigned female at birth may identify as a man. Some transgender people may choose to change their name, appearance, or medical treatment to match their gender identity, while others may not. Every transgender person deserves equal rights, dignity, and respect.

CISGENDER

Cisgender refers to a person whose **gender identity matches the sex assigned to them at birth**. For example, a person who was assigned female at birth and identifies as a woman, or a person assigned male at birth and identifies as a man, is cisgender. The term "cisgender" simply describes this alignment and does not imply any special status or preference.

Difference Between Binary, Non-Binary, Transgender, and Cisgender

Term	Meaning	Example
Binary	Gender is classified into two categories: male and female.	A person identifies as either a man or a woman.
Non-binary	A person does not identify only as male or only as female.	A person identifies outside the traditional male–female categories.
Transgender	A person's gender identity differs from the sex assigned at birth.	Assigned male at birth but identifies as a woman.
Cisgender	A person's gender identity matches the sex assigned at birth.	Assigned female at birth and identifies as a woman.

EXPLORING ATTITUDES TOWARDS GENDER

Exploring attitudes towards gender means understanding and examining the beliefs, opinions, values, and behaviors that people have about different genders. It involves identifying how these attitudes are formed, how they influence people's actions, and whether they promote equality or discrimination.

People's attitudes towards gender are shaped by various factors such as family, education, culture, religion, media, peer groups, and personal experiences. From childhood, individuals

learn what society expects from men and women, and these expectations often influence their thoughts and behavior.

Exploring gender attitudes helps people recognize gender stereotypes, biases, and discriminatory practices that may exist in society. It encourages individuals to question traditional beliefs, respect diversity, and understand that abilities and opportunities should not be limited by gender.

Positive gender attitudes promote equal rights, equal opportunities, shared responsibilities, and mutual respect. They encourage both men and women to participate equally in education, employment, leadership, and decision-making. On the other hand, negative gender attitudes can lead to discrimination, unequal treatment, harassment, and gender-based violence.

Gender sensitization programs, discussions, education, and awareness campaigns help people develop positive attitudes towards gender. By exploring and improving gender attitudes, individuals can contribute to creating a fair, inclusive, and respectful society.

Factors Influencing Gender Attitudes

- Family and upbringing.
- School and education.
- Friends and peer groups.
- Culture and traditions.
- Religion.
- Television, films, and social media.
- Personal experiences.

Importance of Exploring Gender Attitudes

- Helps identify gender stereotypes and biases.
- Promotes gender equality and inclusion.
- Encourages respect for all genders.
- Reduces discrimination and prejudice.
- Creates safe and supportive environments.

- Builds a fair and equitable society.

FACTORS INFLUENCING GENDER ATTITUDES

Gender attitudes are the beliefs, opinions, and behaviors that people have towards different genders. These attitudes are developed over time through various social, cultural, and personal influences. Understanding these factors helps promote gender equality and reduce discrimination.

CONSTRUCTION OF GENDER

Construction of gender refers to the process through which society creates and shapes ideas about how men, women, and people of other gender identities are expected to behave. These expectations are learned through family, education, culture, religion, media, and social interactions rather than being determined by biological differences.

From childhood, individuals are taught gender-specific roles, behaviors, and responsibilities. For example, boys may be encouraged to be strong, independent, and adventurous, while girls may be encouraged to be caring, gentle, and responsible for household work. These expectations are socially created and are known as **gender roles**.

The construction of gender varies across different cultures and changes over time. What is considered appropriate behavior for men and women in one society may be different in another. This shows that gender is a **social and cultural concept**, not a fixed biological characteristic.

The process of constructing gender influences education, career choices, relationships, leadership opportunities, and participation in society. Sometimes, it can also create gender stereotypes and discrimination by limiting people's choices based on traditional beliefs.

Understanding the construction of gender helps individuals recognize that abilities, interests, and responsibilities are not determined by gender. It encourages people to challenge stereotypes, promote equal opportunities, and build a society based on equality, respect, and inclusion.

Agents Involved in the Construction of Gender

- **Family** – Teaches gender roles through upbringing and responsibilities.
- **School** – Shapes attitudes through education, teachers, and textbooks.
- **Peer Groups** – Influence behavior through friendships and social interactions.
- **Media** – Portrays gender roles through television, films, advertisements, and social media.
- **Culture and Religion** – Influence beliefs, customs, and traditions related to gender.
- **Society** – Reinforces gender expectations through social norms and institutions.

Importance of Understanding the Construction of Gender

- Helps identify gender stereotypes.
- Promotes gender equality.
- Encourages equal opportunities for all.
- Reduces discrimination and bias.
- Supports an inclusive and respectful society.

1. Family

The family is the first and most important factor influencing gender attitudes. Parents and family members teach children about gender roles through their behavior, expectations, and responsibilities. For example, assigning household work only to girls or encouraging only boys to pursue certain careers can shape children's attitudes towards gender.

2. Education

Schools and colleges play a significant role in developing gender attitudes. Teachers, textbooks, classroom activities, and interactions with classmates influence students' understanding of gender equality. Gender-sensitive education encourages respect, fairness, and equal opportunities for all.

3. Peer Groups

Friends and classmates influence how individuals think and behave towards different genders. Peer pressure may encourage people to follow traditional gender roles or support gender equality depending on the group's values.

4. Media

Television, films, newspapers, advertisements, social media, and the internet greatly influence gender attitudes. Media can reinforce gender stereotypes or promote positive images of equality by showing women and men sharing responsibilities and participating equally in different professions.

5. Culture and Traditions

Cultural beliefs, customs, and traditions shape society's expectations of men and women. Some traditions promote equality, while others may reinforce gender stereotypes and unequal treatment.

6. Religion

Religious beliefs and practices can influence people's attitudes towards gender roles and responsibilities. Many religious teachings encourage respect and dignity for all, while interpretations may vary across communities.

7. Personal Experiences

An individual's own experiences with family, education, workplace, and society influence their attitudes towards gender. Positive experiences encourage respect and equality, while negative experiences may lead to prejudice or discrimination.

8. Workplace and Society

Workplaces and society influence gender attitudes through employment opportunities, leadership roles, laws, and social interactions. Equal employment policies and gender-sensitive practices help develop positive attitudes towards gender.

Importance of Understanding These Factors

- Promotes gender equality.
- Reduces gender stereotypes and discrimination.
- Encourages equal opportunities for all.
- Creates inclusive and respectful environments.
- Supports social and economic development.

Gender Socialization: Making Women, Making Men

Gender socialization is the process through which society teaches individuals the roles, behaviors, values, and responsibilities considered appropriate for their gender. From childhood, people learn what it means to be a "boy" or a "girl" through the influence of family, schools, friends, media, religion, and culture. This process is often described as **"making women" and "making men"** because society shapes gender identities and expectations over time.

Making Women

"**Making women**" refers to the way society teaches girls the traditional roles and behaviors expected of women. Girls are often encouraged to be caring, polite, patient, gentle, and responsible for household work. They may be expected to help with cooking, cleaning, and caring for younger family members from a young age. Society may also encourage girls to dress, speak, and behave in ways that are considered traditionally feminine.

Although many of these qualities are positive, limiting girls to traditional roles can reduce their opportunities in education, employment, leadership, and decision-making. Modern society encourages girls to develop their talents, pursue higher education, and participate equally in all professions.

Making Men

"**Making men**" refers to the way society teaches boys the traditional roles and behaviors expected of men. Boys are often encouraged to be strong, independent, courageous, competitive,

and financially responsible. They may be told not to cry, to hide their emotions, and to become the primary earners in the family. Society may also expect boys to take leadership roles and make important decisions.

These traditional expectations can place pressure on boys and may discourage them from expressing emotions or sharing household responsibilities. Modern society encourages boys to value kindness, empathy, cooperation, and shared responsibilities while respecting gender equality.

Role of Gender Socialization

Gender socialization influences:

- Personality and behavior.
- Education and career choices.
- Family responsibilities.
- Relationships with others.
- Leadership opportunities.
- Attitudes towards gender equality.

Importance of Positive Gender Socialization

Positive gender socialization teaches that both women and men are equally capable of learning, leading, working, and caring for their families. It encourages individuals to make choices based on their interests and abilities rather than traditional gender stereotypes. This helps create a society based on equality, respect, and equal opportunities for all.

Preparing for womanhood refers to the process through which girls are taught the roles, responsibilities, values, and behaviors that society expects them to follow as they grow into women. This preparation begins in childhood and continues through adolescence and adulthood. It is influenced by family, school, culture, religion, media, and society.

Girls are often encouraged to be caring, polite, patient, obedient, and responsible for household work. They may be taught skills such as cooking, cleaning, and caring for younger family

members. In many societies, girls also receive guidance about personal hygiene, health, safety, education, and responsible decision-making as they approach adulthood.

However, in some communities, traditional expectations may limit girls' freedom, education, career choices, or participation in decision-making. Modern society encourages girls to become educated, independent, confident, and financially self-reliant while enjoying equal rights and opportunities.

Preparing for womanhood should focus not only on traditional responsibilities but also on developing knowledge, leadership, self-confidence, life skills, and equal participation in society.

Importance

- Builds confidence and self-esteem.
- Promotes education and career development.
- Encourages healthy lifestyles and responsible decision-making.
- Supports equal opportunities and women's empowerment.

Growing Up Male

Growing up male refers to the process through which boys learn the roles, behaviors, values, and responsibilities that society expects from men. From childhood, boys are influenced by their family, school, friends, media, culture, and society. Through these influences, they develop ideas about masculinity and how they are expected to behave.

Traditionally, boys are encouraged to be strong, brave, independent, confident, and responsible. They are often expected to become the primary earners of the family and take leadership roles. In many societies, boys are also taught not to cry or openly express their emotions, as emotional expression is sometimes wrongly considered a sign of weakness.

These traditional expectations can place pressure on boys and may limit their freedom to express their feelings or choose careers and interests that do not match gender stereotypes. For example,

a boy may be discouraged from learning dance or becoming a nurse because these are wrongly viewed as "feminine" professions.

Modern society encourages boys to develop positive qualities such as kindness, empathy, honesty, responsibility, cooperation, and respect for all genders. Boys should also be encouraged to share household responsibilities, express their emotions in healthy ways, and support gender equality.

Growing up male should help boys become confident, responsible, and respectful individuals who value equality, diversity, and mutual respect rather than rigid gender stereotypes.

Characteristics of Positive Masculinity

- Respecting all genders equally.
- Expressing emotions in a healthy way.
- Sharing family responsibilities.
- Supporting gender equality.
- Being honest, responsible, and empathetic.
- Rejecting violence and discrimination.

Importance of Understanding Growing Up Male

- Helps reduce harmful gender stereotypes.
- Promotes healthy emotional development.
- Encourages equal participation at home and work.
- Builds respectful relationships.
- Supports gender equality and social justice.

First Lessons in Caste

First Lessons in Caste refers to the process through which children learn about the caste system, caste identities, and caste-based practices from their family, community, school, and society.

These lessons are usually learned during childhood through observation, daily interactions, traditions, and social practices rather than through formal education.

Children may learn about caste through family customs, marriage practices, festivals, occupations, religious beliefs, or the way people interact with others. In some communities, they may also be taught to treat people differently based on their caste. Such ideas are **socially learned** and are not based on a person's ability, character, or worth.

These early lessons can influence children's attitudes and behavior towards others. If children are taught that all people are equal and deserve respect, they are more likely to develop inclusive attitudes. However, if they are taught caste-based prejudice or discrimination, it can lead to inequality and social division.

Education, constitutional values, and awareness programs play an important role in helping children understand that every individual has equal dignity, rights, and opportunities, regardless of caste. Schools should encourage students to respect diversity, reject discrimination, and promote social justice and equality.

Importance of Learning Equality

- Promotes respect for all individuals.
- Reduces caste-based discrimination.
- Encourages social harmony and inclusion.
- Supports constitutional values of equality and justice.
- Builds a fair and democratic society

IMPORTANT QUESTIONS IN UNIT 1

1	Define the term **Gender.**	CO1	K1	2
2	Distinguish between **Sex** and **Gender.**	CO1	K2	2
3	What is meant by **Gender Identity?**	CO1	K1	2
4	Define **Gender Roles.**	CO1	K1	2
5	What is **Gender Socialization**	CO1	K1	2
6	What do you understand by Gender Stereotypes? .	CO1	K2	2
7	Define Gender Equality.	CO1	K1	2

8	What is meant by Patriarchy?	CO1	K1	2
9	Explain the concept of Masculinity.	CO1	K2	2
10	Explain the concept of Femininity.	CO1	K1	2
11	What are the agents of gender socialization?	CO1	K2	2
12	What is meant by the construction of gender?	CO1	K2	2
13	State any two examples of gender discrimination.	CO1	K2	2
14	What is meant by gender bias?	CO1	K1	2
15	Define gender sensitivity.	CO1	K1	2
16	How does family influence gender roles?	CO1	K2	2
17	What role does education play in gender socialization?	CO1	K2	2
18	What are societal expectations regarding womanhood?	CO1	K2	2
19	What are the common stereotypes associated with men?	CO1	K1	2
20	What are the common stereotypes associated with women?	CO1	K1	2
21	Define caste.	CO1	K1	2
22	What is meant by caste-based discrimination?	CO1	K2	2
23	How are gender and caste interconnected?	CO1	K3	2
24	Mention any two impacts of gender inequality.	CO1	K2	2
25	What is the importance of understanding gender in society?	CO1	K2	2

Long Answer Questions

S.No	Question	CO	Bloom's Level	Marks
1	Define gender and explain the basic concepts and terminology associated with gender.	CO1	K2	10
2	Differentiate between sex and gender. Discuss the social construction of gender with suitable examples.	CO1	K4	10
3	Explain the process of gender socialization and discuss the role of family, school, and media in shaping gender identities	CO1	K4	10
4	Discuss the concepts of masculinity and femininity. How do these concepts influence individual behavior?	CO1	K4	10
5	Explain how attitudes towards gender are formed and their impact on society.	CO1	K4	10
6	Discuss the concept of "Making Women" and "Making Men" in the process of gender socialization..	CO1	K4	10
7	Analyze the challenges faced by girls while preparing for womanhood in contemporary society	CO1	K4	10
8	Explain the experiences of growing up male and discuss the societal expectations associated with masculinity.	CO1	K4	10
9	Discuss the relationship between caste and gender. How does caste influence gender roles and opportunities?	CO1	K2	10

10	Explain the importance of gender sensitivity in creating an inclusive and equitable society.	CO1	K2	10